

Brainsquare



The Chronicles
November 2025



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Autumn

Foreword by Mark Van Hamme

Talent returns, opportunities ripen, AI accelerates



Some things make me pause and smile. Recently, we've seen former colleagues return to Brainsquare. Stijn and Wim are back with us. It feels a bit like a return to the "warm nest," a reminder that our culture, connections, and shared values endure. Their return strengthens our teams and, more importantly, underscores how much our people define who we are.

Our business continues to move forward, even in such uncertain times as we're currently navigating. We've welcomed exciting new projects, clients and colleagues. During the last years we have invested in our organization – CFO, marketing, and recruitment – so that we are now ready and capable to take even bigger steps ahead. We're currently exploring opportunities for acquisitions, carefully making sure any future collaboration fits not just with our business goals, but also with our DNA. I'll keep you posted!

Innovation is another constant. Over the summer, we experimented with AI in our own product development. From building fully functional applications from scratch to generating accurate technical documentation, we've seen how AI can accelerate our work and amplify the talents of our teams. The key takeaway? AI technology is an accelerator, not a replacement. Our expertise and experience, for example with governance, privacy, architecture, coding and strategy, remain essential for our customers.

Through all of this, our people remain the heart of Brainsquare. Whether it's new faces joining, returning colleagues, or teams coming together at events like our successful Empowering workshop: your commitment, creativity, and collaboration make progress possible.

Looking ahead, we're ready for what comes next. From continuing to grow our business, to embracing new partnerships and exploring innovative technologies – the path forward is full of opportunity. And it is your dedication, energy, and teamwork that will make it a success.

Yours committed,

Mark Van Hamme

Empowering 2025: An evening of energy and connection

This year's Empowering event took place on October 2nd. We brought colleagues from Brainsquare and Montova together in a setting that perfectly matched the spirit of the evening: elegant, lively and full of warmth: the castle Sint-Michiels in Sint-Katelijne-Waver, a charming, slightly old-world venue.

Guests were welcomed in the grand entrance hall with non-alcoholic drinks (Mark's golden rule for any presentation!), before heading upstairs for a session that easily ran past its planned time, proof of how engaged everyone was. The presentations blended business insight with inspiration, highlighting how far we've come as a company and where we're heading next.

There were talks about recruitment, marketing, and training, but also presentations of Montova, our Managed Services offering, and the services offering for Atlassian. A new MPET project was presented, along with the InterACT project at Atlas Copco. Last, Mark gave us his yearly Empowering update on the Brainsquare Group strategy.

Afterwards, the evening turned into a relaxed walking dinner. Over shared tables and good food, colleagues caught up, exchanged ideas, and overall had a good time – the kind of informal connection that fuels our teamwork throughout the year.

A professional photoshoot ran in parallel, giving everyone a chance to refresh their portrait in style (no more "passport photo" vibes in our internal systems!). Additional photoshoots are planned at the office in November for those who couldn't attend in person. Also, the full presentations and video recording are available to watch.

The Empowering event once again proved what defines us: professionalism, collaboration, and genuine connection, the foundation on which we continue to build our success.



Bru Textiles: a new global customer at Montova



Bru Textiles, headquartered in Kontich, was founded 30 years ago by two South-African brothers, Gary and Jason Neiman. The company has grown into a global distributor of interior furnishing fabrics. They sell tens of millions of metres of fabrics each year to more than 100 countries, supplying leading brands, furniture manufacturers and the hospitality sector. And the name? 'Bru' derives from an African slang word for 'brother'.

Montova's story with Bru Textiles started about a year ago. We were contacted by someone at Bru Textiles who knew our work at another company, and who trusted our expertise in e-invoicing. They were looking for a partner who could help them manage their digital invoicing across multiple countries.

Since then, the project has really taken shape. We've already implemented e-invoicing for Bru Textiles in Malaysia, Serbia, Slovenia, and Italy, with Belgium, Croatia, Saudi Arabia, and the UAE now being prepared. Each country has its own set of rules and local certification needs, so every implementation feels a bit like learning a new language.



It's been a project that has involved all of Montova. The delivery team, of course, where the mappings and connections are implemented, but also the product team where we develop the so-called engines. And last, of course, the support team that helps the customer run the e-invoicing without fail. So it's been a real group effort.

Currently, this project is still all about e-invoicing. It's something we are good at, but it's not Montova's core business, which is connecting internal and external data streams and processes for our partners. So at Bru Textiles, we see e-invoicing as a starting point, with much more potential ahead.

Bru Textiles is a strong global player, and our ambition is also to help them streamline communication and data exchange with all their partners. This is exactly what Montova stands for, building reliable connections that make global business simpler, smarter, and more efficient.

Thomas Van Hoezen & Marc Van Acker

Coming Back to Brainsquare / Montova: Stijn and Wim on leaving, learning, and returning

Sometimes you have to leave a place to see it differently. For Stijn Vandendael and Wim Laureys, that's exactly what happened. Both left Brainsquare in search of something new and both found their way back, with fresh energy and a sense of appreciation.

For Stijn, Montova was his first employer straight out of school. "It was all I knew," he says. "At some point, I convinced myself I needed more structure, more focus on development, the kind of thing you supposedly find in a big company." So he joined a large organization with dozens of teams, detailed procedures, and layers of hierarchy. "It didn't take long to realize I'd lost something important," he admits. "I could write code, but I didn't see what happened with it. I missed that full circle: developing, delivering, and getting feedback from real customers. That's what makes the work meaningful for me, I found out."

Back at Montova as Expert Software Engineer, he now sees things differently. "I used to focus on what bothered me. Now I see what makes this place special: the trust, the direct contact, the ability to make an impact. It's like the old saying: the grass isn't always greener on the other side. But sometimes you need to stand on that other side to see that."

Wim's story echoes that sentiment. He started at Brainsquare back in 2013 and took up various sales positions. When Montova became a company instead of a product, he assumed the role of Montova's sales manager. After eight and a half years, he wanted to take an opportunity at a large and global tech company. "It was impressive at first," he says. "Big names, big budgets, big targets. But I realized after some time that in those environments, you're only as good as your last month. You don't build and grow. It's all short-term wins. What I missed was the long game: building relationships, growing a company."

When the opportunity came to rejoin Brainsquare as sales manager at the group level, it felt right. "This company has definitely grown and is very ambitious, but it is still no-nonsense and human. That is a rare combination," he says.

Both men agree that Brainsquare and Montova have something you can't easily replicate: a genuine connection between people, trust in what you do, and the freedom to grow. As Wim puts it: "We're not just colleagues. We're part of something we actually believe in."



Stijn Vandendael & Wim Laureys

Bringing structure, security and scalability to MPET



MPET in the Port of Antwerp is Europe's largest container terminal, handling up to 9 million standard containers each year. With a quay stretching 3.7 kilometers and 38 quay cranes, it manages ships carrying up to 23,000 containers. It's a massive operation, and every movement of cargo relies on precision and coordination.

At MPET, Brainsquare is tasked with upgrading the administrative tool for the Tally team, the administrative dockworkers responsible for the accurate documentation and verification of all cargo movements on the terminal. Any vessel and container, at any time – day or night, weekday or weekend – is managed by the Tally administration. Whether it's determining the arrival and departure of containers, allocating them to a ship or voyage, or repairing damaged containers, Tally take ownership so the dock workers in the field know what to do.



Until now, the Tally team relied on a shared mailbox system to process thousands of daily messages. Brainsquare is upgrading this with a cloud-based application built on Microsoft Azure and developed in .NET. It keeps the familiar look and feel of an inbox, so that the change is fairly transparent for the Tally workers. At the back, however, the new application adds structure, security, and scalability. Multiple users will be able to collaborate in real time, while a "dossier" brings together all emails, documents, and actions for a complete view on an event, from customs inspections to maintenance requests.

The first development wave, currently underway with Bart Van Houtte leading as solution architect, focuses on core functionality and user adoption. If accepted by MPET, iterative enhancements through 2026 will introduce intelligent automation: content-based task assignment, guided next actions, and smarter workflows, always keeping human oversight at the center.

The Brainsquare Group is no stranger to MPET: Montova's EDI integration services already connect MPET's operations with external partners, shipping lines, and logistics providers. It's a perfect example of how the diverse expertise and services within our group reinforce one another, helping to build a long-lasting partnership that delivers real value for our customers: smarter processes, better collaboration, and sustainable growth.

The MPET project is also a testcase. For us to see how well we collaborate with the customer in view of a more encompassing collaboration, and for MPET to see the future potential of Brainsquare as a partner for their ambitious developments around their TOS (Terminal Operating System), the heart of their operations and steep ambitions.

Geert Judong

Meet Thomas Dejan: “There is no I in Team”



Last May, Thomas Dejan joined Montova as Service Delivery Manager, leading the helpdesk and implementation teams. Thomas has a background that bridges technology, teamwork, and customer focus. He brings with him close to two decades of experience, from developer to project manager to service delivery lead.

Thomas Dejan first crossed paths with Brainsquare through another Thomas (Van Hoezen), who thought he'd be a perfect fit for Montova. One smooth conversation with Mark later, and Thomas was ready to take the leap. “It motivated me right from the start,” he says.

Thomas lives in Bilzen with his wife and their energetic eight-year-old son, who he calls “my hero.” “I sometimes think I learn more from him than he learns from me,” Thomas smiles. “With him, I experience my second youth.”

Outside of work, Thomas is a sports enthusiast turned golfer, drawn to the game's balance of focus and reflection. “Golf teaches you to think strategically, learn from mistakes, and keep moving forward,” he says. “That mindset helps in leadership too: staying calm, adapting, and improving step by step, hole by hole.” The lessons from the golf course, he believes, could also inspire colleagues at Montova. “It's not just a game; it's about patience, mindset, and resilience,” he adds. “Maybe one day, we could organize a team golf initiation at Montova, also to experience how much it points to ways we can grow as a person, in both private life and work.”

In his new role, Thomas is helping Montova's teams collaborate more efficiently and with greater purpose. Today, he manages the helpdesk and implementation teams and goes a long way to ensure a smooth customer experience. But beyond processes and planning, what drives him most is people. “When you invest in people, help them grow, give them confidence, and make them feel supported, the possibilities are endless,” he says. “That's how you build stronger teams, and that's where real progress begins.”

Beyond work, Thomas enjoys good food, travel, and time with family. Skiing in winter, exploring new places in summer, he recharges through discovery and shared experiences. His dream trip? New Zealand has been high on the list for a long time.

True to Brainsquare's spirit, Thomas believes teamwork is everything. As he said in his part of the Empowering presentations: “There's no I in team. To quote a Daft Punk song, together we become Harder, Better, Faster, Stronger.”

Thomas Dejan

Atlas Copco's GEMS project: a high-stakes, long-term commitment for Brainsquare



Brainsquare is currently working on one of Atlas Copco's most ambitious IT transformations ever: The global manufacturer is replacing its long-standing BPCS ERP system on mainframe with a new SAP platform. Internally, the program is known as GEMS, and it's much more than an IT migration: it's also about rethinking and redefining Atlas Copco's digital landscape.

The guiding principle for Atlas Copco is "keeping the core clean." Rather than customizing SAP itself, the core SAP will be left unchanged and all integrations happen around it. This approach allows Atlas Copco to keep upgrading their SAP core without having to adapt and retest GEMS with every SAP upgrade.

To make that possible, Brainsquare is building an integration framework around SAP using event-driven technology based on .NET, a future-proof solution. We manage the full chain, from governance and analysis to solution design, development, deployment, and long-term operations. Our team, around 15 strong, is divided in a build team, which creates and delivers the integrations, and a run team, which ensures stability and continuity.

The new system is already live at two smaller sites: in Houston (US) and Oosterhout (NL). And just around this time, we are organizing a transition and go-live at two larger production plants in India. These are very large sites, employing thousands of people. Needless to say, we're entering this phase with a bit of excitement and nerves.

Once this stage is complete, we'll move into a regular rhythm, rolling out one site after another, roughly one per three months. The aim is to complete the rollout of the 30 entities by 2030. That will be quite a challenge, though, especially because the Antwerp production entities are also included. Those are the most complex ones, the heart of Atlas Copco, full of engineers who constantly have new ideas. So the scope there is enormous, and downtime is not an option.

Previously, the ERP system was heavily customized to Atlas Copco's exact needs. The ERP was the master of everything: if it wasn't in the ERP, it didn't exist. Now, not only are Atlas Copco switching systems, but they are also changing that mindset. Concretely: many business concepts in Atlas Copco, operational, logistical, or marketing-related, don't fit neatly inside SAP's standard structure, but will have to be implemented nevertheless. We need to absorb all those demands. Sometimes that's challenging, and it puts real pressure on the team. As the integration partner, we're literally building change at Atlas Copco!

That's also why this project matters so much. This is one of the largest, most strategic projects we've run for Atlas Copco, and it shows the depth of trust they place in us. It's also definitely the largest project at an industrial partner that we've ever run at Brainsquare, and our people are doing a superb job!

Steven Put



Welcome to the Bite Size Sessions calendar page! Here you'll find a complete list of all our upcoming sessions, along with dates, times, and any additional details you need to know. Our calendar is updated regularly, so be sure to check back often or [subscribe](#) to below calendar to see what new sessions we have coming up.

Type	Date	Subject	Speaker
QB	12 November 2025	Explaining .NET C# solution template setup	Ronny Ruyters
QB	11 December 2025	Agile retrospective	Veronique Decock
QB	January 2026	Quarkus LangChain4J	Rolf Dobbelaere
QB	February 2026	Prompting	Jorden Van Bogaert
DD		Enterprise Architecture	Geert Judong

Veronique Decock - Michel Thomassen



Welcome to our new colleagues!



May 19th 2025

Ashishkumar Chaurasiya - EAI Support - B² - India



May 19th 2025

Pravin Wagh - .Net Software Engineer - B² - India



July 14th 2025

Tushar Kokare - Java/Oracle Support Engineer - B² - India



July 31st 2025

Pallavi Trivedi - .Net Software Engineer - B² - India



August 13th 2025

Vijay Kamble - .Net Developer - B² - India



September 1st 2025

Sunil Nishad - Test Automation Engineer - B² - India



September 8th 2025

Pooja Awale - .Net Core API Software Engineer - B² - India



September 8th 2025

Adarsh Birangal - Medior Java/Oracle Support Engineer - B² - India



September 15th 2025

Mayur Talashilkar - Java/Oracle Support Engineer - B² - India



October 1st 2025

Wim Laureys - Sales Manager - B² - Belgium

Welcome to our new colleagues!



October 10th 2025

Rahul Naidu - Roll-out Engineer - B² - India

Subcontractors



May 19th 2025

Kurt Du Bois - Senior Java Software Engineer - Belgium



June 2nd 2025

Bart Van Houtte - Solution Architect - Belgium



October 3rd 2025

Herbert Mincke - Solution Architect - Belgium



October 10th 2025

Jonas Lauwerysen - Front-end React Engineer - Belgium



November 4th 2025

Thomas Deyaert - Senior .Net Software Engineer - Belgium



Feel free to send any ideas for new topics, suggestions or comments to [Nathalie](#)